How to Spot Fake Hype: A 3-Check Field Guide

Every week a new product is declared the next big thing — and nobody checks. Hype-r Report scores the hype 0-100: REAL, HALF HYPE, or FAKE. This is the method.

The problem: launch-day noise vs real demand

One-day spikes are cheap. A cute photo can trend for a day on images alone, and "selling out everywhere" often comes from the brand's own marketing. Real demand behaves differently: it leaves public traces, and it survives the gap between the launch moment and the next one — a restock, a second weekly menu, a follow-up release. Three checks separate the two.

Check 1 — A demand signal you can see without trusting the brand

Real demand leaves public traces: restock dates being announced (and then actually mattering), queues or limits per customer, resale listings at above-retail prices that actually sell, and conversation that continues after the launch-day posts stop.

If the only source for "selling out everywhere" is the brand's own marketing, treat it as unproven.

Check 2 — Is the excitement about the product, or borrowed?

A lot of "viral" products are riding a movie release, a celebrity, a season, or a bigger brand's audience. That does not make the product bad — it makes the hype borrowed. Borrowed hype fades on the bigger thing's schedule, not the product's.

In our scoring, this is the most common reason an item lands in the middle band rather than the top.

Check 3 — Does the hype survive a gap?

Hype that is still alive at a second moment — a restock, a second weekly menu, a follow-up release a month later — is behaving like demand.

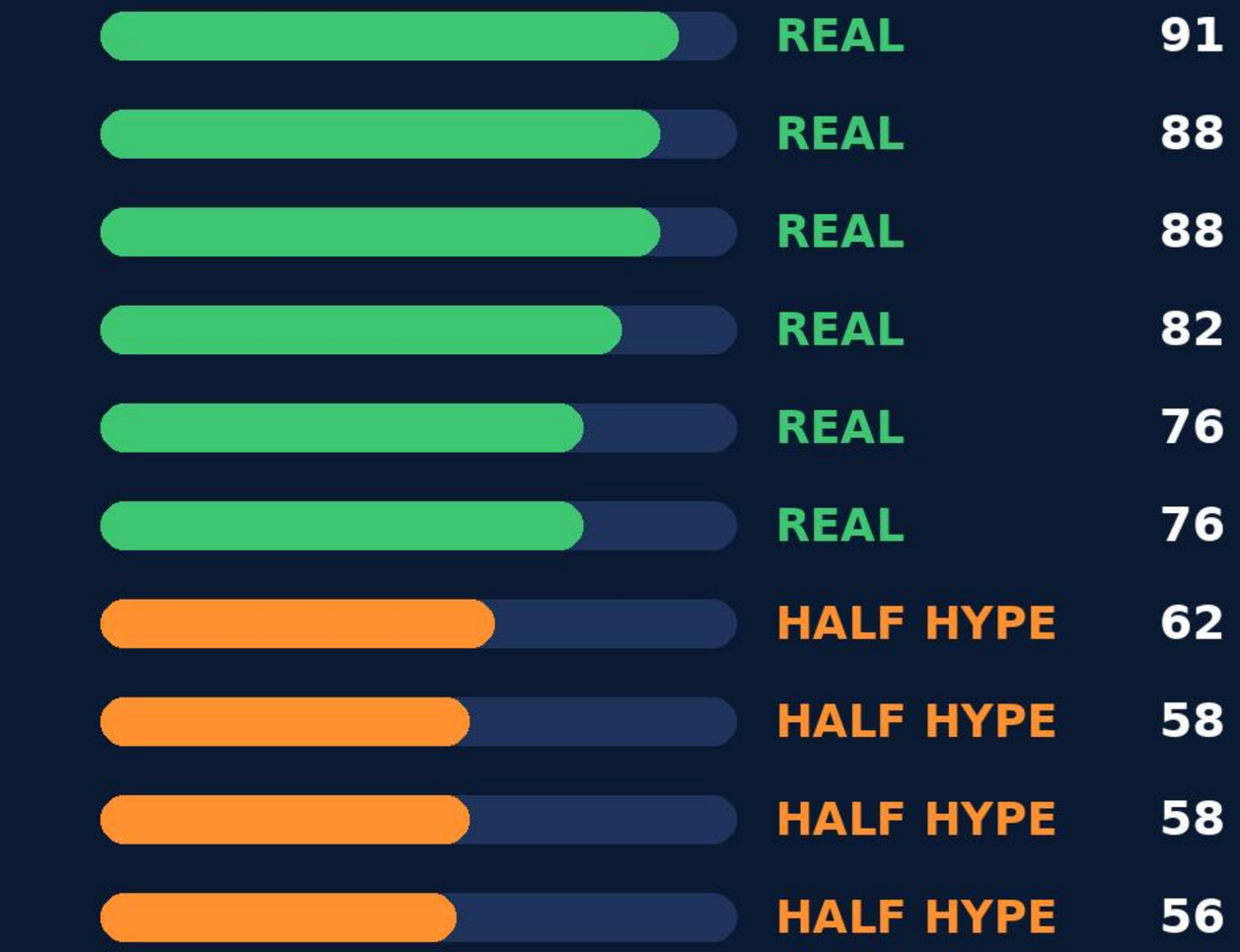
So score before release, note the next scheduled moment in advance, and re-check after it. A verdict published early, with a date attached, cannot be quietly rewritten later.

The scoreboard: HYPE SCORE 0-100

REAL **70-100**	You found independent demand signals.
HALF HYPE **40-69**	A real product — with excitement running ahead of the evidence.
FAKE **0-39**	The claims fall apart in public data: invented sell-outs, staged scarcity, accounts repeating each other.

The bands never move to fit a result. Scores are fixed at publication.

The ledger so far: 10 published verdicts



Case cards

Starbucks Bearista Cup — REAL 91

Drinkware hype is easy to fake. What made this one different was structure: a staged release, a surprise-box mechanic, and a restock date that turned one drop into two separate demand events.

Dubai Chocolate — REAL 82

Demand signals visible well beyond the brand's own posts — the conversation kept going after the launch moment instead of dying with it.

Stanley Cup — HALF HYPE 58

The product itself is fine — sometimes genuinely good. What is missing is proportionality: the conversation is larger than the underlying demand.

Keep your own ledger

Being wrong in public, on a dated post, teaches you more about hype than being right in private ever will.

Publish the score early. Write down the next scheduled moment. Then re-check and publish the result — we call those follow-ups Hype Receipts. A verdict system that never revisits itself is just fortune-telling with better graphics.

Every verdict, on the record

VERDICT DATABASE — all 10 verdicts with scores and video links

https://tokyotalesjp.github.io/hype-report-verdicts/

YOUTUBE — Hype-r Report (@Hype-rReport)

https://www.youtube.com/@Hype-rReport

START WITH THE BEARISTA VERDICT (60s)

https://youtube.com/shorts/CDgvpHc7V0w

Disagree with a score? That is the point. Team MAX, or Team AMBER?